



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate

SEP 2021

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September



Are you on
Facebook?

[Join our private
Minnehaha
Community Page!](#)

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011



Office Hours

We are starting to keep some office hours this fall. Heather will be working from the office on Tuesdays and Thursday from 10-4. The rest of the time she will be working from home and can be reached through email, office@minnehaha.org. If you need access to the building outside of those hours, please be in contact with Heather to get a key or make special arrangements.

Revisions to our Mask Policy

Our Covid Task Force met in mid-August, and we are once again revising our mask policy.

- Masks are required for everyone in our common spaces at church
- Masks will continue to be required for all indoor worship services
- Masks continue to be optional for outdoor worship and activities

Worship in September

See the article elsewhere for the details on when/where we are worshiping this fall. The brief summary is that for September, we are still with one service at 10:00, still outside.

In September, we are beginning a sermon series that looks at our beliefs. What we believe matters, and it impacts the ways we regard one another, the ways we treat the world, and the ways in which we act. We'll explore big concepts, like Original Sin, as well as explore things like why we pray. And, on September 26, we'll recognize the students who participated in confirmation last year. Join us in the lawn or online!

September 5	"Faith and Works"	<i>James 2:1-10, 14-17</i>
September 12	"Sticks and Stones May Break My Bones, But Words . . ." <i>Children & Youth Program Year Begins</i>	<i>James 3:1-12</i>
September 19	"Original Sin"	<i>James 3:13-4:3, 7-8a</i>
September 26	"Is There Power in Prayer?" <i>Confirmation</i>	<i>James 5:13-20</i>





SEPTEMBER



Our summer programs are wrapping up, and Children, Youth, and Family Teams are hard at work making plans for the 2021-2022 Program Year at Minnehaha.

Once again, September will not look like we thought it would, even six weeks ago. And so, we're putting all that we've learned about pivoting, communicating, assessing, letting go of expectations, having grace with ourselves, and being resilient to good work. Some days, most certainly, it's easier than others. And, being in community with each other feels just as important, if not more so, than ever. In our August survey, families expressed the desire to have in-person opportunities, safely outside. We've applied this to how we planned our September and early October.

Here's what you can expect in programming through October 17th:

1. We'll be outside as much as we possibly can. If weather brings us inside, masks are required
2. Sunday School will be outside, divided by age level (with some all group time mixed in)
3. We will not be resuming Child Care at this point
4. All volunteers working with children and youth will need to show proof of vaccination
5. We'll take this step-by-step. We've planned through October 17th, and will be assessing where we are in early October before making plans for the next chunk of time
6. Many have expressed exhaustion, and we get it. We're continually looking for ways that we can support one another, and fill one another's cup.

Please be sure to take time to complete the Faith Formation Program Registration (available on our website) so that we can plan accurately for classes. And, contact me if you have any questions!

With love,

Jenia Strom

Director of Children, Youth, and Family Ministries
education@minnehaha.org.



PARENT CHECK-INS

Join us weekly during the Sunday School hour while your kids are in Sunday School for a parent check-in.

Hosted by Children's Council, we'll gather outside (specific location TBD) to connect with and support one another.

We're looking at some other opportunities for time for parents' - and look to brainstorm some of these during this time.

September 12th, 19th, and 26th: at 11am

October 3rd, 10th, and 17th: at 10am

WE NEED YOU!

For what: To help with Children & Youth Ministries. Lead a class, help prep spaces, host an event, there are countless ways we can use your talents and time.

When: there are opportunities to help weekly on Sunday mornings, monthly on Wednesday evenings, and for special events.

How: Fill out the volunteer form on the website or contact Jenia at education@minnehaha.org



ALL VOLUNTEERS MUST BE VACCINATED

MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

YOUTH GROUP

2021-2022 KICK-OFF

Sept. 12th

4-5:30pm



The Minnehaha Youth Group is for **ALL YOUTH IN 6TH-12TH GRADE.**

Youth Group will meet weekly on **Sundays from 4-5:30pm.**

We also hope youth will join us for Sunday School on Sunday Mornings.

In September, we will meet after our single outside service at 11am.

Questions? Want to be added to our mailing list?
Contact Jenia at education@minnehaha.org



YOUTH ROOM UPDATES

We're working to update our Youth Rooms, and adding an additional room for our Senior High Youth. If you have a couch, end table, or lamp that needs a home - let us know and we might be able to put them to good use!

CELEBRATE AUTUMN'S ARRIVAL

MINNEHAHA SIDE LAWN
WEDNESDAY, 22ND SEPTEMBER

Join Minnehaha Kids & their Families
for a magical evening to welcome fall.
We'll have music, crafts, and more.



We'll have a pizza picnic at 5:30pm (\$5/person);
Activities will follow from 6-7pm.

All ages welcome.

No need to bring anything - but if you've been looking for a chance to wear those fairy wings or acorn hat: this might in fact, be it!



Help with Sound, Projection, and Camera

We are looking for a few adults and youth who are willing to help out with our sound system, our projection, and our livestreaming cameras. As we begin to plan for two services and indoor worship, we need folks to help us make that all happen. Coordinators of each of those areas will provide training and help us work out a schedule. And, cross-training is encouraged! You are welcome to volunteer for more than one of these area. If you want to learn about sound, talk to Jefferson Slinkard. Jim Bohl is happy to show you how easy it is to operate the cameras for livestreaming, and Sue Johnson is doing training for projection.

MinneHarvest

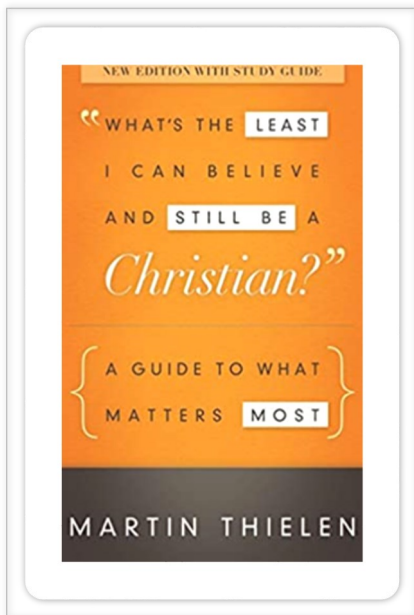
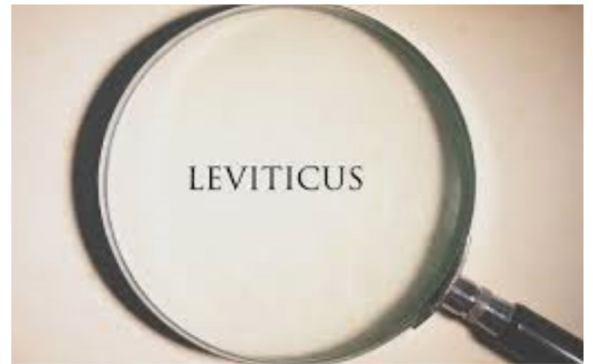
Our free food give-away once a month (on the fourth Saturday of the month) is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us on September 25. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the truck starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend (and a mask)!



Rules

We are spending a lot of time in our country determining, debating, and defying the various rules that help us be community. In the midst of this national conversation (confrontation), you are invited to take a step back in time and study the rules that guided the early Hebrew community. Yup, we are going to study Leviticus! Don't worry, it's only for five weeks ☺ We'll gather on Tuesday afternoons at 2:00 from September 14 through October 12 in person at the church, and there will also be an online option. If you are interested in joining through zoom, please let Becky know prior to September 14 so she can get the technology set up appropriately.

The rules in Leviticus are fascinating, and we'll study them in groupings to help us understand how they functioned in their own time.



What Do I Believe?

This fall, there will be a class held on zoom on Monday nights that explores what we do, and don't, believe. Based on the book *What's the Least I Can Believe and Still Be a Christian* by Martin Thielen, we'll spend 5 weeks looking at the things we don't believe, and 5 weeks looking at things we do believe, with a final week to wrap it all up. Classes start on Sept. 13 and end on November 29. If you are interested, please buy the book and read chapters 1 & 2 prior to Sept. 13. Please also contact Becky for the zoom link to the class.

Adult Sunday Faith Forums in September

Adult Faith Formation will start again this fall, following the 10:00 worship service.

- Sunday, September 19 – “Prison Abolition and Higher Education in Minnesota” presented by Matthew Palombo
- Sunday, September 26 – no forum that day
- Sunday, October 3 – “Black Liberation Theology in South Africa” presented by Matthew Palombo

Our Synthetic Kids

Carol Spearman will again be offering her class on Healthy Eating for families in September (more details to come.) If you would like to pick up a FREE copy of the book in advance, they are in the big wooden box by the front doors



United
Methodist
Women

United Methodist Women

- Your UMW has been busy this month, prepping for a return of the annual Fall Rummage Sale. Gathering rummage (drop it off at church on Sundays, Aug. 29 and Sept. 5), finding volunteers, sorting, and selling, our proceeds from the sale will be split with the MUMC Finance and into our UMW funds. Please be sure to come and buy on Sept. 9, 10 and 11th with a bag day on the afternoon of the 11th. You are more than welcome to help us move “leftovers” from the sale to become donations at the end of the sale.
- We are pleased to announce that two of MUMC’s recent high school graduates have been awarded scholarship funds from your UMW.

Hannah Scholen (Eastview High, Class of ‘21) will be attending the University of Nebraska-Lincoln and writes “I’ve found a family in the Methodicals band and am constantly encouraged to step outside my comfort zone and become a more capable and confident musician. Being a member of MUMC has truly made me a stronger, faith-driven person.”

Isaac Kramer (Southwest High, Class of ‘21) will attend the College of Science and Engineering at the University of Minnesota. He writes: “I would love to be chosen for this scholarship to help me further my education at the U of M. I want to be able to use the values that were taught at church, such as being generous, charitable and accepting of all other people.”

Good luck to both and all other folks beginning the 2021-2022 school year!

- We are once more serving dinners at Simpson Shelter (28th St. E. and 1st Ave. So.) on the following dates: Wed. Sept. 29, Wed., Oct. 27 and Mon. Nov. 11. We like to serve on dates that follow the MInneharvest so we can benefit from the food supply at that event; the funds for the rest of the meal for over 110 people comes from the UMW. We’ll need cooks during those days at our church kitchen along with servers at Simpson starting at 5:45. Please let Maureen Trepp (612-387-2520) know if you’d like to help.
- Upcoming events:
 - ⇒ We are beginning to do funeral reception serving again! Please let Kim Kanuit (612-860-0256) know that you can help out with this or baking bars for the receptions.
 - ⇒ Nov. 13! Annual Holiday Bazaar! Save the date and consider being a vendor!
- Happy State Fair (I hope) and Labor Day! Peace, Maureen Trepp (*UMW President*)



OLD FASHIONED Church Rummage Sale

**Lots of great stuff!
Housewares & Linens.
Toys. Books. Electronics.
And more!
(But no clothes)**



**Thursday, Friday & Saturday
Sept. 9, 10 & 11**

Day	Date	Time
Thursday	September 9	9:00 a.m. – 6:00 p.m.
Friday	September 10	9:00 a.m. – 3:00 p.m.
Saturday	September 11	9:00 a.m. – 3:00 p.m.

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
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In-Person Worship Continues This Fall

We will continue worshipping in person this fall, and we will also continue to livestream the services (we plan on always doing this going forward). Since the delta variant of Covid is still out there, our goal is to remain outside as long as possible. When we do go inside, masks will be required for everyone.

Here are the details:

September will be a continuation of our summer plan – outside with one service at 10:00. If it rains, we'll go into the sanctuary and ask that everyone wear masks.

- Faith formation will return for adults on September 19 at 10:00, inside
- Faith formation for children and youth will return on September 12 outside in the side lawn with parents encouraged to attend with their children/youth.

October will see a return to our two worship services, and we will begin to offer a regular indoor option.

- 9:00 will be our “traditional but not stuffy” service, inside, with masks. There will be limited congregational singing.
- 10:00 will continue with Faith Formation for adults inside and children/youth outside
- 11:15 will be our “non-traditional” service, outside (as weather permits) on Oct. 3, 10, 17
- Beginning Oct. 25, the second service will return to our 11:00 time and will move inside. Masks will be required, and there will be limited congregational singing.

Livestreaming will continue to be found on the website, and you will still receive an email through October 17 with the links, and notes about whether the second service is inside or outside. After that, we will discontinue the Sunday morning emails, but both services will be available simply by going to the website and clicking on the “Worship” link.

We look forward to seeing you in worship!

Note
from the
pastor



Be The Light

At the last minute, Scott Gruenhagen asked if I could open the August Church Council meeting with a prayer or devotion. “Just a minute,” I said, “I was just reading a Mary Oliver poem this morning that I think will work.” The poem is called *When I Am Among the Trees*, and the author imagines a conversation with the trees. It closes with the trees telling her (and us), “and you too have come into the world to do this, to go easy, to be filled with light, and to shine.”

These days, light is hard to come by. If you want bad news about the ongoing pandemic, or about the plight of women in Afghanistan, or about the devastations wrought by wildfires, hurricanes, droughts, floods, earthquakes, you can easily find that. You can hear about the frustration of teachers and students. You can easily find stories of police brutality, and stories about good police officers who face the taunts of individuals and crowds. Stories of the criminals who get away, about parents who don’t care for their children, and about senseless violence permeate our news. So, in the face of all that, we are to be filled with light and to shine! I’m not going to pretend that this is easy. Nor do I have 3 simple steps to get us there. No, instead, this is our life’s work. John Wesley had three rules – 1. Do No Harm 2. Do Good 3. Stay in Love with God. Again, not easy. But if we stay in love with God, I think the doing no harm and the doing good get a little clearer. And, if we are staying in love with God, not doing harm, and doing good, I’d like to think that not only are we experiencing light, we are beginning to shine as well.

On the last night of my Boundary Waters trip this year, we had experienced an afternoon of clouds. No rain, but the sky was overcast. Just before sunset, the cloud system reached its edge, so that just as the sun got to the western horizon, it found clear sky. Suddenly, light lit up the eastern side of the lake. The trees caught the fading sunlight, and the underside of the clouds reflected the setting sun back onto the surface of the lake. A loon landed on the surface of the orange rippled lake surface, and it was clearly raining up in the higher atmosphere (even though it wasn’t reaching the ground) because a full rainbow arced across the lake. We were hoping to see the Perseid Meteor Shower, but we got a whole different kind of light show instead.

Even though getting into the BWCA is hard work, and we were being bitten by flies and knew we had a big wind on a big lake to face the next day, we were filled with the light. I returned to all the bad news around us, but I am still shining. I know we are all worn down by difficult decisions, and we are frustrated by the things we have no power over. But the trees in Mary Oliver’s poem still call to us. God still calls to us. Go easy, be filled with light, and shine.



In Joy,

Becky



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9/21



Church Spruce-Up

As we prepare to re-enter the church with fall indoor worship and faith formation, we believe that it'd be a great opportunity to spruce things up in our shared spaces! Some rooms look untouched in a time – freeze since we left them last March of 2020! Details are to follow, but the goal is that we organize small groups to tackle spruce – up or cleanup projects to be ready for our return to in-person gatherings. Examples of what's needed to do include

- Discard dated materials (2019 art projects, expired materials, etc)
- Coordinating with church facilities on any cleanup (if needed)
 - o Windows
 - o Floors
 - o Dusting
 - o Etc.
 - o Refresh décor and ensure all materials are in the proper rooms
 - o Decorate for fall
 - o Ensure each classrooms has appropriate chairs, tables, desks, etc
 - o Inventory what supplies are needed

Have supplies available to ensure sanitization and hygiene (spare masks, soaps and sanitizers, air purifiers, etc)



TIMING – To be announced soon, but aiming for various small groups to coordinate efforts in late September – Early October.